

tion and position of the shapes and text boxes can be changed by you. The Frame button allows the image border to be created or modified, making it easy to have a circular or oval border instead of the usual rectangular one.

Multiple effects can be applied to the same image, though while moving from one effect to the other without saving the results of the previous effect, Picnik alerts you to either save or discard the changes made. However, considering that there is no limit to the steps that can be undone with the undo button, you can experiment to your heart's content without having to worry about starting all over again.

The mouse wheel can be used to control the level of Zoom. This is a nifty feature and is available throughout the interface. The context menu can be accessed by right-clicking anywhere on the interface, and allows quicker access to the main menu options.

The final image can be saved on the PC, or directly sent to the same online image hosting sites like Flickr or Photobucket. The file formats supported are JPG, GIF, TIFF and PDF.

Fortunately, Picnik doesn't grey out the premium options which make it easier for you to discover the additional available features and also discern whether it is worth paying. There are some premium effects that are really interesting and worth experimenting with.

3.1.3 Pixenate.com

This is an AJAX-powered site. It is considerably quicker off the block than Picnik because the interface is lighter. But the flipside is that it features fewer tools and a higher amount of data transfer, causing delays with every action.

Pixenate only supports the JPG file format, and integrates only with Facebook allowing the editing of images uploaded to that site. Online images can be loaded for editing by providing the URL.

The site offers basic tools such as Crop, Resize and Rotate. The



Picnik's shape options